

Which of the following is LEAST likely to occur when the administration and delivery of health care is organized as a bureaucracy?

- ☐ A. Licensing for health care providers is impersonal and standardized [7%]
- ☐ B. Health care providers and administrators have separate and specialized roles [2%]
- ☐ C. There is a clear chain of command among health care providers and administrators [4%]
- ✔ ☒ D. Health care providers treat each patient as unique and administer personalized patient care [85%]

Correct

86% answered correctly

Explanation:

Defining features of bureaucracies (bureaucratic organizations)
• Division of labor: Specialized employees increase efficiency • Hierarchical organization: Centralized authority & clear chain of command • Standardization: Formal procedures & rules increase uniformity & continuity • Impersonal: Same impersonal criteria applied to all increase equality

Bureaucracy, a modern form of organization adopted by complex societies, is designed to be **rational** and maximize **efficiency**. An **ideal bureaucracy** is characterized by the following:

- **Division of labor** increases efficiency through specialization (individuals focus on their area of expertise)
- **Hierarchical structure** provides a clear chain of command enabling everyone to understand their role
- **Standardization** of clear rules/procedures ensures continuity and uniformity
- **Impersonal** processes for hiring/promoting (based on merit) and handling clients foster equal treatment

Actual bureaucracies often have some, but not necessarily all, of the characteristics of an *ideal* bureaucracy.

If the administration and delivery of health care is organized as a bureaucracy, personalized patient care would be *least* likely to occur because bureaucracies are typically characterized by impersonality and standardization (not personalization and flexibility).

(Choice A) Licensing for health care providers that is impersonal (based on merit) and standardized (formal, uniform) *is* likely to occur in a bureaucracy.

(Choice B) Health care providers and administrators who have separate and specialized roles reflect a division of labor, which *is* likely to occur in a bureaucracy.

(Choice C) A clear chain of command among health care providers and administrators reflects a hierarchical organization, which *is* likely to occur in a bureaucracy.

Educational objective:

Ideal bureaucracies use division of labor, hierarchical structure, standardization, and impersonality to maximize rationality and efficiency. Actual bureaucracies often have some, but not necessarily all, of the characteristics of an ideal bureaucracy.

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